

Steel Cod API v1

API version 1.3

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Security

API Keys

The API keys are tied to a specific **partner** (such as a POS or ERP vendor) and **company** (such as an appliance store)¹. Multiple keys can be active for a partner/company at one time to ensure continuity of service. Right now keys are only available upon request, but in the future we plan on having a partner portal where partners can generate their own API keys for a company.

Authentication

Currently, the API key is part of the data payload for ease of use. However, we *could* move it into the HTTP header and use Basic authentication, where the API key would be the username and the password would be blank.

Authorization

API keys allow the partner to act on behalf of anyone at the company for which the API key is provided. Steel Cod will not provide an OAuth authentication mechanism for individual users. Therefore, the burden of individual user authentication and authorization is on the partner's consuming application.

NOTE: DO NOT CREATE A NEW STEEL COD ACCOUNT FOR THE SOLE PURPOSE OF CREATING SPEC PACKAGES THROUGH THE API. CREATING SUCH AN ACCOUNT IS AGAINST THE STEEL COD END USER AGREEMENT AND WILL RESULT IN THE ACCOUNT BEING DEACTIVATED. INSTEAD, PASS IN THE EMAIL ADDRESS OF THE USER ACCOUNT YOUR SYSTEM HAS AUTHENTICATED AND IS ACTING ON BEHALF OF.

HTTPS

All calls to the Steel Cod API must be made via JSON-formatted payloads over HTTPS.

¹ If a company is doing its own customization, then it is considered both the partner and company in this scenario.

Process Guidelines

While most of this document is dedicated to the technical requirements of the Steel Cod API, there are a few process guidelines we ask you to follow:

- The API is a way to create **project-based spec packages**, just as the email, scan, and search functions currently do on the site.
- The API is not intended to return individual spec sheets one at a time. For example, do not create a “Download Spec” button on your public-facing website for a specific model and then use the API to surface this content.
- The API must be user-initiated: that means a salesperson on your side must specifically request a spec package for a project and we will generate it for you.
- Do not use automated triggers to generate spec package creation.
- Do not use the same salesperson on every spec package. It must be the person requesting the package. That user must be registered in Steel Cod, and it’s your responsibility to authenticate them.

Failure to follow these process guidelines could result in your API access being permanently revoked.

Backward Compatibility

Version 1.3 is designed to be **fully backwards-compatible** with any consuming application that has been developed against any previous 1.x version. No breaking changes will ever be made against future iterations of Version 1.

Spec package URLs

All spec packages have a public base URL. This is a link to a Steel Cod web page that displays details about the spec package and includes links to the public URLs. When a salesperson is logged in, private URLs will appear on this page as well.

All public and private URLs for a spec package are derived from **the base public URL plus a URL suffix**:

- Public URL suffixes:
 - **/Open** – view full spec package in browser
 - **/Download** – download full spec package
 - **/SlimOpen** – view slim spec package in browser
 - **/SlimDownload** – download slim spec package
 - **/Json** – public JSON representation of spec package, no authentication needed
 - **/Ask** – form that allows non-authenticated users to send questions to the salesperson
- Private URL suffixes:
 - **/Edit** – link where salesperson can edit the package
 - **/PremEdit** – link where salesperson can create, edit or delete the Premium Spec Package (PSP) associated with this package

Often an API function returns only the base public URL, but you can easily determine the URLs for the public and private URLs. For example:

- The API returns the **public base URL**:
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9>
- Apply the suffixes for the **public URLs**:
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/Open>
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/Download>
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/SlimOpen>
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/SlimDownload>
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/Json>
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/Ask>
- And the **private URLs**:
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/Edit>
 - <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/PremEdit>

Functions

The API currently contains six functions:

- **CreateSpecPackage** – create a new spec package
- **DeleteSpecPackage** – delete an existing spec package
- **SearchSpecPackages** – retrieve basic spec package info based on document ID, title, or personally identifiable information (PII)
- **RetrieveSpecPackage** – retrieve detailed information about a single spec package
- **RetrieveUsers** – retrieve a list of all registered company users
- **ToggleDocumentInclusion** – toggle the inclusion of a document in an existing full/slim spec package
[added in version 1.3]

CreateSpecPackage Function

POST <http://api.steelcod.com/v1/createSpecPackage>

The CreateSpecPackage function accepts information about a given quote/sales order, including model numbers and customer information. The result contains links to the compiled spec package and the details page, the spec documents found, etc.

Inputs

- **apiKey** – *string* – identifies the partner and company
- **userEmail** – *string* – the email address of the user that is submitting the scan
 - The email address must match an active user already registered in Steel Cod to the given company.
- **salespersonEmail** – *string* – the email address of the salesperson that should be associated with the scan
 - Optional
 - The email address must match an active user already registered in Steel Cod to the given company.
- **documentID** – *string* – the ID of the quote/sales order.
 - If no value is provided, one will be automatically generated by the system.
- **emailTo** – *string array* – list of email addresses to send the resulting compiled spec document
 - To be used for sending a copy of the compiled spec doc as an attachment to the salesperson, submitter or store administrator; not designed to send to the customer, as it will contain the details link that will be accessible only by the company users
- **customer** – *object* – details about the customer, including: name, ID, phone, email, notes
- **address** – *object* – address of the quote/sales order, including: line1, line2, city, stateOrProvince, postalCode, country
 - Optional
- **projectPartner** – *string* – name of the partner on the project
- **modelNumbers** – *string array* – list of model numbers for which to search.
 - Model numbers can include spaces and other non-alphanumeric characters, such as hyphens, slashes, and dashes.
 - Mandatory if not using the “modelGroups” field
- **modelGroups** – *dictionary of string, string array* – list of model numbers grouped by divider titles.
[added in version 1.3]
 - Similar to the “modelNumbers” field, except that the model numbers are grouped together so users can easily generate PSPs without having to manually sort their model numbers into different sections.
 - The dictionary key is the title of the section.
 - This does **not create a new PSP** – it just *pre-assembles the sections* with the given titles and model numbers in the PSP editor if the user decides to create a PSP using the PSP Editor on the Steel Cod Enterprise website. There is no API call to create or update PSPs.
 - Mandatory if not using the “modelNumbers” field
- **title** – *string* – title of the project

- Optional; will default to document ID if not provided and no previous version of package found
- **subtitle** – *string* – subtitle of the project
 - Optional
- **documentTypeLabel** – *string* – describes what type of input document is being processed
 - Optional; will default to “Package” if not provided and no previous version of package found
 - Examples you would expect to use: “Sales Order”, “Invoice”, “Estimate”, etc.
- **coverPageFullPackage** – *string* – name of the cover page to use for the full spec package
 - Optional; if omitted, default full spec package cover page will be selected
 - Special value: **NONE**
 - If “NONE” is passed as value, the full spec package will not have a cover page
- **coverPageSlimPackage** – *string* – name of the cover page to use for the slim spec package
 - Optional; if omitted, default slim spec package cover page will be selected
 - Special value: **NONE**
 - If “NONE” is passed as value, the slim spec package will not have a cover page

Output – Successful

Successful calls will return an HTTP 200 code along with the following data object in JSON format.

- **specPackageUrl** – *string* – public base URL of the resulting spec package.
 - See the “Spec Package URLs” section of this document for more information.
- **navId** – *string* – Steel Cod ID of the spec package
- **details** – *object*
 - **detailsUrl** – *string* – private URL to the details page of the quote/sales order.
 - This URL is only accessible by company users and is not for public consumption.
 - **documentId** – *string* – ID of the quote or sales order; will be autogenerated if no value provided in the input object
 - **salesperson** – *object* – details of the salesperson who is associated with the quote/sales order
 - **found** – *string array* – list of model numbers that were found and are not excluded from results
 - **excluded** – *object array* – list of model numbers that are excluded due to company rules excluding certain manufacturers, categories, or model numbers²
 - **modelName** – *string* – model number of the excluded model
 - **manufacturer** – *string*
 - **category** – *string*
 - **exclusionMessage** – *string* – the message to users for why this item was excluded
 - **isGlobalExclusion** – *boolean* – value of the field that is causing the model to be excluded
 - **missing** – *string array* – list of model numbers that were not found in the Steel Cod database
 - **specs** – *object array* – list of specs that are associated with the compiled spec document
 - **fileName** – *string* – name of the individual spec sheet found

² Added in 1.0.53_beta

- **isIncluded** – *boolean* – indicates whether the spec sheet is contained in the compiled spec document
- **specCategories** – *object array* – any special categories that describe documents with non-standard content. An empty array usually means the document is a standard specification document written in English. [added in version 1.2.84]
 - **name** – *string* – examples: “Use and Care Guide”, “French”
 - **categoryType** – *string* – examples: “Content”, “Language”
- **models** – *object array* – models associated with the individual spec
 - **modelNumber** – *string*
 - **category** – *string*
 - **manufacturer** – *string*
 - **sku** – *string* [added in version 1.2.84]
- **xUid** – *string* – the unique identifier for this document / spec package major version combination; used to include/exclude the document via the ToggleDocumentInclusion() method [added in version 1.3]
 - Note that this xUid value will change if the document undergoes a major revision. To retrieve the very latest xUid values, use the JSON URL for the spec package.
 - Example: <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/Json>
- **newQuestionsCount** – *integer* – number of questions that have been submitted through the Ask page and have not been acknowledged yet
- **logID** – *string* – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting
- **apiVersion** – *string* – the current version of the API
- **warningCodes** – *dictionary of string, string* – lists warnings about the input values. These are just warnings and do not prevent the successful processing of the request. Current warning codes include:
 - **2001**: No salesperson – no salesperson found on input
 - **2002**: No document ID – no document ID found on input, so one was auto-generated
 - **2003**: Invalid or duplicate model numbers – invalid or duplicate model numbers found on input
 - **2004**: No title
 - **2005**: No subtitle
 - **2006**: No document type label

See the “Errors and Error Codes” section for more details about server and client errors.

DeleteSpecPackage Function

POST <http://api.steelcod.com/v1/deleteSpecPackage>

This function deletes a spec package from the database. The public URL to the spec package remains active but the end user will receive a message saying that the spec package that was at that URL has been removed. All details and potentially personally identifiable information (PII) are purged from the database. **Please use this function with caution as this action cannot be undone.**

Inputs

- **apiKey** – *string* – identifies the partner and company
- **userEmail** – *string* – the email address of the user that is deleting the spec package
 - The email address must match an active user already registered in Steel Cod to the given company.
- **navId** – *string* – the Steel Cod ID of the spec package to be deleted

Output – Successful

Successful calls will return an HTTP 200 code along with the following data object in JSON format.

- **specPackageUrl** – *string* – public base URL of the deleted spec package that can be used to confirm the package has been deleted
- **navId** – *string* – Steel Cod ID of the spec package
- **isSuccess** – *boolean* – at the time of this writing this value will always be set to true
- **logID** – *string* – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting
- **apiVersion** – *string* – the current version of the API

See the “Errors and Error Codes” section for more details about server and client errors.

SearchSpecPackages Function

POST <http://api.steelcod.com/v1/searchSpecPackages>

This function returns basic information about spec packages that match the search parameters. If no search parameters are specified, it will simply return all spec packages for the company. Note that large queries will only return a portion of the search results at one time. Records are returned by spec package creation date in descending order.

Search parameters are cumulative: a spec package must satisfy *all* search criteria in order to be returned in the result set.

Search parameter value matching is *case-insensitive*.

Inputs

- **apiKey** – *string* – identifies the partner and company
- **userEmail** – *string* – the email address of the user that is submitting the search
 - The email address must match an active user already registered in Steel Cod to the given company.
- **skip** – *integer* – the consuming application can “skip” the first *X* records in the dataset by passing in this value. For example, if 6,500 matching records are found and only 2,500 records (see footnote³) are returned at a time, a second call to this function can use “2,500” as the skip value to return records 2,501 through 5,000, a third call can use “5,000” to return records 5,001 through 6,500.
 - Optional
- **title** – *string* – return spec packages where the title **begins** with this value
 - Optional search parameter
- **createdByUserEmail** – *string* – return spec packages where the spec package was created by the user with this email address
 - Optional search parameter
- **salespersonUserEmail** – *string* – return spec packages where the salesperson listed on the spec package is the user with this email address
 - Optional search parameter
- **documentID** – *string* – return spec packages where the document ID title **exactly matches** this value
 - Optional search parameter
- **pii** – *string* – match all spec packages where any field that could contain personally identifiable information (PII) **contains** this value
 - Optional search parameter

³ Note that the 2,500 limit in this example is an arbitrary limit used for illustrative purposes. The actual limit on the number of records returned may go up or down at any time so you should not hard code your application with a specific limit. Instead, you should use the values returned in the response to programmatically determine a.) if more records exist and b.) how many more records to skip to get the next data set.

Output – Successful

Successful calls will return an HTTP 200 code along with the following data object in JSON format.

- **specPackages** – *object array* – high-level details of the matched spec packages, order by created on date (descending)
 - **navId** – *string* – the Steel Cod spec package ID
 - **title** – *string*
 - **subtitle** – *string*
 - **deleted** – *boolean*
 - **docId** – *string* – the ID of the document that was passed into Steel Cod
 - **publicUrl** – *string* – public base URL of spec package
 - See the “Spec Package URLs” section of this document for more information.
 - **salespersonEmail** – *string*
 - **salespersonFullName** – *string*
 - **createdOn** – *datetime*
 - **createdByEmail** – *string*
 - **createdByFullName** – *string*
 - **updatedOn** – *datetime*
 - **updatedByEmail** – *string*
 - **updatedByFullName** – *string*
- **totalRecords** – *int* – total number of spec packages that match the search parameters
- **returnedRecords** – *int* – the number of records returned in the **specPackages** array
- **startIndex** – *int* – the one-based index of the first record of the **specPackages** array in the context of the entire record set that was matched
- **logId** – *string* – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting
- **apiVersion** – *string* – the current version of the API

See the “Errors and Error Codes” section for more details about server and client errors.

RetrieveSpecPackage Function

POST <http://api.steelcod.com/v1/retrieveSpecPackage>

This function returns the current details of a single spec package.

Inputs

- **apiKey** – *string* – identifies the partner and company
- **userEmail** – *string* – the email address of the user that is retrieving the spec package details
 - The email address must match an active user already registered in Steel Cod to the given company.
- **navId** – *string* – the Steel Cod ID of the spec package to be deleted

Output – Successful

Successful calls will return an HTTP 200 code along with the following data object in JSON format.

- **specPackageDetails** – *object* – [please refer to the **details** property of the CreateSpecPackage response object, which is identical to this object]
- **navId** – *string* – Steel Cod ID of the spec package
- **found** – *boolean* – the package was successfully found in the database
- **deleted** – *boolean* – the package has been deleted from the database
- **logId** – *string* – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting
- **apiVersion** – *string* – the current version of the API

See the “Errors and Error Codes” section for more details about server and client errors.

RetrieveUsers Function

POST <http://api.steelcod.com/v1/retrieveUsers>

This function returns high-level details for all company users.

Inputs

- **apiKey** – *string* – identifies the partner and company
- **userEmail** – *string* – the email address of the user that is retrieving the user list
 - The email address must match an active user already registered in Steel Cod to the given company.

Output – Successful

Successful calls will return an HTTP 200 code along with the following data object in JSON format.

- **users** – *object array* – high-level details of each user
 - **email** – *string*
 - **fullName** – *string*
 - **firstName** – *string*
 - **lastName** – *string*
 - **location** – *string*
 - **registeredOn** – *datetime*
 - **isEnabled** – *boolean*
 - **isAdvancedUser** – *boolean*
 - **isPaymentManager** – *boolean*
- **enabledUserCount** – *integer* – the number of users currently enabled
- **disabledUserCount** – *integer* – the number of users currently disabled
- **logID** – *string* – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting
- **apiVersion** – *string* – the current version of the API

See the “Errors and Error Codes” section for more details about server and client errors.

ToggleDocumentInclusion Function

POST <http://api.steelcod.com/v1/toggleDocumentInclusion>

[Added in version 1.3]

This function will include or exclude a specific document that was associated with an existing spec package when the spec package was created. It is not designed to add new documents or models to an existing package.

Inputs

- **apiKey** – *string* – identifies the partner and company
- **userEmail** – *string* – the email address of the user that is toggling the status of the document
 - The email address must match an active user already registered in Steel Cod to the given company.
- **navId** – *string* – the Steel Cod ID of the spec package to be updated
- **xUid** – *string* – the ID of the document that is to be updated
 - This ID is specific to this combination of document and spec package major version.
 - The xUid can be found in two places:
 - CreateSpecPackage() response
 - Note that the xUid is updated when the spec package undergoes a major revision. The xUid returned in the CreateSpecPackage() response may not be valid for the entire lifecycle of the spec package.
 - The JSON url of the spec package
 - Example: <https://www.steelcod.com/sp/iron/TDM1QIV9/Json>
 - This URL will always contain the latest valid xUid values
- **include** – *boolean* – whether the document should be included in the full/slim spec packages
 - Optional (but recommended for clarity). If this value is missing from the input payload, the function will include the document if it's currently excluded, and vice versa.

Output – Successful

Successful calls will return an HTTP 200 code along with the following data object in JSON format.

- **isIncluded** – *boolean* – the updated status of the document in reference to the full/slim spec package
- **isChange** – *boolean* – whether or not this is a change from the previous status. For example, if the request was to exclude the document but the document was already excluded, this value would be **false** because there was no change to the spec package.
- **fileName** – *string* – the name of the document
- **specCategories** – *object array* – if the document is associated with any categories, they will be displayed here
 - **name** – *string*
 - **categoryType** – *string* – will be one of two values: “Content” or “Language”

- **logID** – *string* – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting
- **apiVersion** – *string* – the current version of the API

See the “Errors and Error Codes” section for more details about server and client errors.

Errors and Error Codes

The API can return two types of errors for **all functions**: server errors and client errors.

Output – Server error

If the API unexpectedly encounters an error it will return an HTTP 500 code along with an object describing the error.

- **serverErrorMessage** – string – error message
- **logID** – string – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting

Output – Client error

If the API encounters a known problem with the input of a request it will return an HTTP 400 code along with the following data object in JSON format. The data issue should be fixed before the call is attempted again.

- **errorCode** – *integer* – code of the error
- **errorMessage** – *string* – name of the error; is fixed along with errorCode value (see below)
- **errorDetails** – *string* – contains more details about why the error was encountered
- **logID** – string – ID of the current transaction; can be used for logging and troubleshooting

General API error codes

- **1001**: No api key
- **1002**: Api key wrong format
- **1003**: Api key not found
- **1004**: Api key not active
- **1005**: No payload detected
- **1006**: Company not found
- **1007**: Company not active
- **1008**: User not specified
- **1009**: User not found
- **1010**: User not active

CreateSpecPackage error codes

- **1011**: Model numbers required
 - As of **Version 1.3**, model numbers can be passed through *either* the **modelNumbers** array *or* the **modelGroups** dictionary in the request payload
- **1012**: Customer name required
- ~~• **1013**: Address required~~
 - Removed since address is now optional as of 1.0.52

DeleteSpecPackage error codes

- **1101**: No NavId value provided

- **1102:** NavId not found – this must be the Steel Cod spec package ID, not the company's internal doc ID
- **1103:** Unauthorized company
- **1104:** Already deleted

SearchSpecPackages error codes

- **1201:** Skip value cannot be negative

RetrieveSpecPackage error codes

- **1301:** No NavId value provided

ToggleDocumentInclusion error codes [Added in version 1.3]

- **1501:** No xUid value was specified
- **1502:** No NavId value was specified
- **1503:** The NavId provided was not found
- **1504:** The xUid was an invalid format
- **1505:** The xUid was not found
- **1506:** The spec package was deleted and cannot be updated
- **1507:** The spec package belongs to a different company and cannot be updated
- **1508:** The document is in a state that cannot be included or excluded

More General API error codes

- **1401:** Steel Cod Lite user
- **1402:** API Module not enabled for company – if you run into this, please contact us at help@steelcod.com

Document Versions

- **Version 1** – November 21, 2017
 - Document created
- **Version 2** – December 3, 2017
 - Changes to **address** input object
 - “state” is now “stateOrProvince”
 - “zip” is now “postalCode”
 - “country” is a new field
 - Added optional “projectPartner” field to input object
 - Added “logID” to client error response
 - Converted server error response from a string to an object
 - Added “tz” (salesperson time zone) to salesperson output object
 - Added “apiVersion” to all output objects
 - Added “documentID” to the output **details** object
- **Version 3** – December 5, 2017
 - Address is now optional on input object
- **Version 4** – February 4, 2018
 - Various internal changes to accommodate Steel Cod Version 1.14 release
 - Added “excluded” to the **details** object
- **Version 5** – February 22, 2019
 - API minor version upgrade: 1.1.60
 - This should be a non-breaking change for consuming applications as additional fields are all optional.
 - API is no longer considered to be in the “beta” stage
 - Various internal changes to accommodate Steel Cod Version 1.17 release
 - Addition of three new optional fields: “title”, “subtitle”, “documentTypeLabel”
- **Version 6** – December 15, 2019
 - Added new functions:
 - RetrieveUsers
 - RetriveSpecPackage
 - SearchSpecPackages
 - DeleteSpecPackage
 - Added new fields to CreateSpecPackage request:
 - coverPageFullPackage
 - coverPageSlimPackage
 - Added new fields to CreateSpecPackage response:
 - navId
 - details.fullSpecPackage
 - details.slimSpecPackage
- **Version 7** – April 20, 2020
 - Added new error code API validation:
 - Steel Cod Lite user (error code 1401)
- **Version 8** – n/a

- Version 9 – September 19, 2020
 - Added documentation around new public **/Json** and **/Ask** URLs
 - Added **newQuestionsCount** to specPackageDetails object
- Version 10 – November 7, 2020
 - Added **sku** to models object in spec package details
 - Added **specCategories** to specs object in spec package details
- Version 11 – March 13, 2023
 - Added disclaimer about creating a new SC account for the sole purpose of creating spec packages through the API
 - Added **"/PremEdit"** URL information for Premium Spec Packages (PSPs)
- Version 12 – July 31, 2026
 - Incremented the minor version from "1.2" to "1.3"
 - Added new function: **ToggleDocumentInclusion()**
 - Added **xUid** to createSpecPackage response
 - Facilitates the use of the new ToggleDocumentInclusion() function
 - Added **modelGroups** to createSpecPackage request
 - Facilitates the creation of PSPs (but does not create the PSP itself) by automatically populating divider titles and model numbers in PSP Editor